



Hard Link & Soft Link – MCQ Test



Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Instructions: Answer all questions. Each question carries **1 mark**.

Form Link: <https://forms.gle/rfVz9j2ETApEfBc6>

1) What does an inode store?

- A) File name
- B) File metadata
- C) File extension
- D) File password



Answer: B) File metadata

2) Which command is used to check inode number?

- A) ls -l
- B) ls -a
- C) ls -li
- D) cat -i



Answer: C) ls -li

3) A Hard Link points to:

- A) File path
- B) Another shortcut
- C) Actual data (same inode)
- D) Remote server



Answer: C) Actual data (same inode)

4 Which command creates a Hard Link?

- A) ln -s file1 file2
- B) ln file1 file2
- C) link -s file1 file2
- D) cp file1 file2

✓ Answer: B) ln file1 file2

5 Hard links share:

- A) Different inode numbers
- B) Same inode number
- C) Different file size
- D) Different permissions

✓ Answer: B) Same inode number

6 Can a Hard Link be created for directories?

- A) Yes
- B) No
- C) Only by root
- D) Only in ext4

✓ Answer: B) No

7 Hard Links can:

- A) Cross filesystems
- B) Cross partitions
- C) Cross devices
- D) Not cross filesystems

✓ Answer: D) Not cross filesystems

8 What happens if the original file of a Hard Link is deleted?

- A) Data is deleted immediately
- B) System crashes
- C) Data remains until link count is 0
- D) File becomes shortcut

✓ **Answer: C) Data remains until link count is 0**

9 The number 2 in `-rw-r--r-- 2 user user` indicates:

- A) File size
- B) Number of users
- C) Hard link count
- D) Version number

✓ **Answer: C) Hard link count**

10 A Soft Link points to:

- A) Actual data
- B) File inode
- C) File path
- D) RAM

✓ **Answer: C) File path**

11 Which command creates a Soft Link?

- A) `ln file1 file2`
- B) `ln -s file1 file2`
- C) `cp -s file1 file2`
- D) `link file1 file2`

✓ **Answer: B) `ln -s file1 file2`**

12 Soft Link has:

- A) Same inode as original
- B) No inode

- C) Different inode
- D) Same link count

✓ Answer: C) Different inode

13 Soft Links can link:

- A) Only files
- B) Only directories
- C) Files and directories
- D) Only root files

✓ Answer: C) Files and directories

14 Soft Links can:

- A) Not cross filesystem
- B) Cross filesystem
- C) Only work in ext4
- D) Work only in same partition

✓ Answer: B) Cross filesystem

15 If the original file of a Soft Link is deleted:

- A) Data remains
- B) Link becomes hard link
- C) Link breaks (dangling link)
- D) System reboots

✓ Answer: C) Link breaks (dangling link)

16 Which symbol identifies a Soft Link in `ls -l`?

- A) ->
- B) =>
- C) ==
- D) **

✓ Answer: A) ->

17) Which link helps save disk space without duplicating data?

- A) Copy
- B) Soft Link
- C) Hard Link
- D) Move

✓ Answer: C) Hard Link

18) Which link is commonly used to manage software versions?

- A) Hard Link
- B) Soft Link
- C) Copy
- D) Tar

✓ Answer: B) Soft Link

19) What happens when link count becomes 0?

- A) File becomes soft link
- B) Data is permanently deleted
- C) File becomes hidden
- D) Nothing happens

✓ Answer: B) Data is permanently deleted

20) Which of the following is TRUE?

- A) Hard link has different inode
- B) Soft link shares same inode
- C) Hard link cannot link directories
- D) Soft link survives original deletion

✓ Answer: C) Hard link cannot link directories

